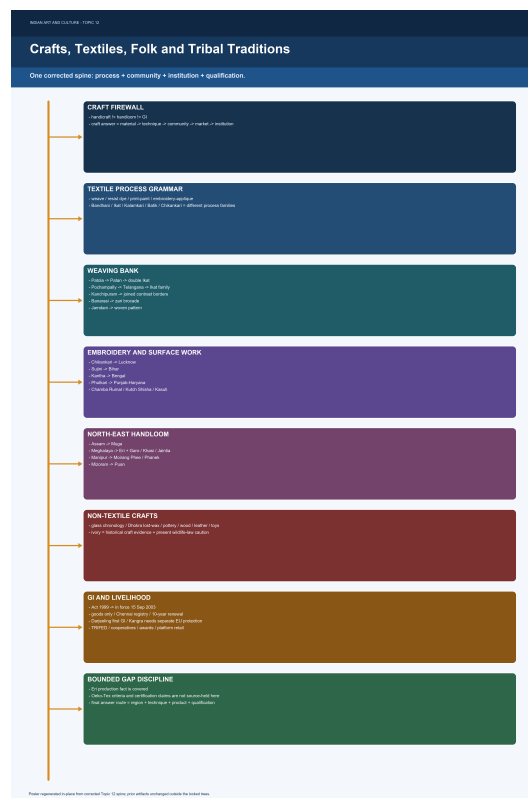


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Crafts, Textiles, Folk and Tribal Traditions - Solved Practice Workbook

Standalone workbook | full-Markdown render | 32 original MCQs + PYQs + original Mains answers



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

Crafts, Textiles, Folk and Tribal Traditions - Solved Practice Workbook

This standalone workbook carries exactly 32 original MCQs with strict ABCD rotation, 2 verified objective / application PYQs with answer-withholding discipline, and 6 full original Mains model answers. No direct GS-I Mains PYQ is routed solely to Topic 12.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

CORE UPSC MCQS

Q1. Which statement is the safest opening distinction for Topic 12?

A. Handloom is a loom-woven textile subset, handicraft is the wider hand-made field, and GI is a separate origin-linked legal instrument. B. Handloom, handicraft and GI are three names for the same recognition category. C. Every tribal craft is automatically a handloom product. D. Once a product gets a GI, its production process no longer matters.

Answer: A.

Explanation: A is correct because Topic 12 begins with a classification firewall. The other options collapse production type, community identity and legal recognition into one category.

Q2. Which formulation best captures the craft-ecology chain?

A. Only visual beauty matters; raw material and market can be ignored. B. A craft survives through linked raw material, technique, producing community, market access, institutional support and transmission. C. Craft decline can always be solved by a museum display alone. D. Once a product is exported, community identity is no longer relevant.

Answer: B.

Explanation: B is correct because it states the full causal chain behind continuity. The other choices remove essential links such as materials, market or transmission.

Q3. Which statement best expresses the limit of GI protection?

A. GI status automatically guarantees artisan income and ecological sustainability. B. GI status is the same as UNESCO heritage status. C. A GI protects an origin-linked product name for authorised users, but does not by itself secure wages, raw materials or skill transmission. D. GI status means the product can only be studied as law, not as culture.

Answer: C.

Explanation: C is correct because the legal layer is narrower than total safeguarding. The other options exaggerate GI into a welfare or UNESCO instrument.

Q4. Which statement about continuity in Indian craft traditions is safest?

A. Continuity means the product must remain identical in motif and labour relation across time. B. A surviving product name proves that the original patronage system survives unchanged. C. Colonial and post-colonial markets had no effect on craft traditions. D. Continuity is best read as selective adaptation under changing patrons, markets and institutions.

Answer: D.

Explanation: D is correct because continuity in this topic is adaptive, not frozen. The other statements confuse survival with unchanging production.

Q5. Which statement about Indian glass craft chronology is correct?

A. Nitin records a long chain from epic and Vedic references to Painted Grey Ware evidence and the Brahmapuri-Kolhapur industry. B. Glassmaking appears only in Mughal India and has no earlier evidence. C. The first evidence for glass is the GI Registry in Chennai. D. Indian glass history is outside Topic 12 because it is not a textile.

Answer: A.

Explanation: A is correct because Topic 12 explicitly includes glassware and its chronology. The other options ignore early textual and archaeological evidence or shrink the syllabus to textiles alone.

Q6. Which pair most safely belongs together?

A. Bandhani - supplementary-weft zari brocade B. Laharia - wave-like tie-and-dye variation associated in Nitin with Jaipur and Jodhpur C. Ikat - white-thread embroidery from Lucknow D. Batik - pre-dyed yarn weaving method

Answer: B.

Explanation: B is correct because Laharia is described as a special wave-like tie-and-dye route. The other options deliberately swap weave, embroidery and wax-resist techniques.

Q7. Which statement correctly distinguishes Patola from Pochampally?

A. Both are embroidery traditions from Lucknow. B. Patola is Banarasi zari work, while Pochampally is Chikankari. C. Patola belongs to Patan and is classically treated as double ikat, while Pochampally belongs to Telangana within the ikat family. D. Patola is a GI for tea, while Pochampally is a GI for timber.

Answer: C.

Explanation: C is correct because it attaches both locality and technique. The distractors mix textiles with unrelated crafts or legal categories.

Q8. Which statement about Kanchipuram and Banarasi is safest?

A. Both are identical tie-and-dye traditions. B. Kanchipuram and Banarasi are both simply generic silk names with no technical markers. C. Banarasi is a painted cotton textile and Kanchipuram is a block print. D. Kanchipuram is known for contrasting borders joined to the body, while Banarasi is known for supplementary-weft zari brocade.

Answer: D.

Explanation: D is correct because it ties each textile to its core technical marker. The other options erase the process differences.

Q9. Which statement about Jamdani and Tanchoi is correct?

A. Nitin treats Jamdani as muslin weaving with opaque designs on a transparent base and Tanchoi as a Varanasi weaving tradition shaped through trade-linked influence. B. Jamdani is the same as Chikankari, while Tanchoi is the same as Batik. C. Both are only surface-painting traditions of Andhra Pradesh. D. Neither belongs to the textile history of India.

Answer: A.

Explanation: A is correct because it preserves both the Bengal-Jamdani and Varanasi-Tanchoi routes. The other options confuse weaving with embroidery or painting.

Q10. Which statement best distinguishes Chikankari from Kantha?

A. Chikankari is wax-resist dyeing, while Kantha is brocade weaving. B. Chikankari is Lucknow's white-thread embroidery, while Kantha is Bengal's running-stitch quilting or embroidery associated with reused cloth. C. Chikankari and Kantha are both Assam silk categories. D. Kantha is a metal-casting process and Chikankari is a GI statute.

Answer: B.

Explanation: B is correct because it keeps both region and process straight. The distractors turn embroidery into dyeing, weaving or law.

Q11. Which group is correctly matched?

A. Phulkari - Kashmir; Kasuti - Gujarat; Kutch Shisha - Bengal B. Chamba Rumal - Telangana print; Phulkari - Tamil Nadu weave; Kasuti - Assam silk C. Phulkari belongs to the Punjab-Haryana route, Kasuti to Karnataka cross-stitch work, and Kutch Shisha to mirror work in Gujarat. D. All three are identical forms of Ikat.

Answer: C.

Explanation: C is correct because each tradition is tied to its recognised regional and technical identity. The other groups deliberately scramble states and processes.

Q12. Which statement about Kalamkari, Batik and applique is safest?

A. Kalamkari is a metallic thread embroidery and Batik is a shawl weave. B. Applique means resist-dyed yarn before weaving. C. Batik originated in the Nilgiris and proves Toda embroidery. D. Kalamkari is painted or printed cotton, Batik uses wax-resist colouring, and Pipli applique joins coloured fabric pieces into one worked surface.

Answer: D.

Explanation: D is correct because it preserves the surface-process differences. The other choices swap unrelated textile techniques.

Q13. Which statement most safely distinguishes Assam from Meghalaya in the North-East textile bank?

A. Assam is linked in Nitin to golden Muga silk, while Meghalaya is the book's explicitly named Eri silk route. B. Assam and Meghalaya are indistinguishable because both mention garments. C. Meghalaya is famous only for Banarasi brocade. D. Eri and Muga are the same fibre and should be used interchangeably.

Answer: A.

Explanation: A is correct because the book explicitly separates Assam's Muga from Meghalaya's Eri route. The other options erase the key discriminator.

Q14. Which statement about Meghalaya is correct for this topic?

A. It is the principal route for white-thread Chikankari. B. Nitin names the Garo, Khasi and Jaintia communities, and states that Eri silk is commonly produced there along with shawls, sarongs and mekhela chadors. C. It is presented as the original home of Banarasi brocade. D. It is used in Topic 12 only for GI law, not for textile production.

Answer: B.

Explanation: B is correct because it reproduces the exact structure of the corrected evidence bank: community, fibre and garments together. The distractors import unrelated textile traditions.

Q15. Which statement best captures North-East textile diversity?

A. The whole region can be safely reduced to one common textile pattern. B. Only Assam has any historically important weaving tradition. C. Manipur's Moirang Phee and Phanek, Nagaland's tribe-specific motifs, and Mizoram's Puan together show that the region must be described through differentiated local traditions. D. North-East textiles are outside art and culture because they belong only to economics.

Answer: C.

Explanation: C is correct because it resists regional flattening and uses named examples. The other choices deny the very diversity the sources stress.

Q16. Which statement about Dhokra is safest?

A. It is a tea GI from the Himalayan region. B. It is the same as Chikankari embroidery. C. It refers only to mirror work in Gujarat. D. It denotes a lost-wax non-ferrous metal-casting tradition associated with artisan communities across central and eastern India.

Answer: D.

Explanation: D is correct because Dhokra is used in Topic 12 as a process-based metal-craft marker. The other options confuse it with textile or agricultural products.

Q17. Which statement about ivory craft is safest?

A. It belongs to historical craft study, but present-day answers must acknowledge wildlife-law restrictions and avoid presenting fresh ivory production as safeguarding. B. It should be promoted today without legal qualification because it is old. C. It has no place in Indian craft history. D. Its only relevance is that it proves every craft today is GI-protected.

Answer: A.

Explanation: A is correct because the topic requires both historical evidence and present legal caution. The other choices either romanticise or erase the craft.

Q18. Which pair is correctly matched?

A. Maheshwari - wax-resist cloth from Indonesia B. Himroo - courtly dress and shawl material associated in Nitin with Aurangabad C. Chamba Rumal - Assam silk category D. Kasuti - EU GI tea from Himachal Pradesh

Answer: B.

Explanation: B is correct because Nitin places Himroo in Aurangabad and links it to royal dress and shawl use. The other pairs scramble unrelated traditions.

Q19. Which statement about community and institution is safest?

A. TRIFED exists only to classify ancient scripts. B. GI registration eliminates the need for any market-support institution. C. TRIFED's official role as an apex body under the Ministry of Tribal Affairs supports the point that tribal crafts now work through organised marketing as well as inherited skill. D. A tribal craft becomes non-tribal the moment it is sold in a city.

Answer: C.

Explanation: C is correct because it links community skill to institutional marketing without romanticising isolation. The other statements are plainly unrelated or simplistic.

Q20. Which statement about current handloom-award records is safest for Topic 12?

A. They prove that every awarded product is GI-tagged and eco-certified. B. They make Nitin's textile classifications unnecessary. C. They can be used to infer official answers for old UPSC prelims questions. D. They may be cited only as dated evidence of continuing institutional recognition of weaving skill, not as proof of unrelated GI or certification claims.

Answer: D.

Explanation: D is correct because the repair uses the official handloom-award records narrowly and honestly. The distractors over-extend what those records prove.

Q21. Which statement about the GI instrument is correct?

A. India's GI law is the Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999, brought into force in 2003 and applying to goods rather than services. B. GI registration is a UNESCO programme for intangible heritage. C. GI law applies only to textiles and excludes tea or timber. D. GI registration in India is permanent and non-renewable.

Answer: A.

Explanation: A is correct because it states the statute and scope precisely. The other options confuse GI with UNESCO, shrink its scope or get the term wrong.

Q22. Which statement about Darjeeling Tea and Kangra Tea is safest?

A. Both are used in Topic 12 only because they are embroidered shawls. B. Darjeeling Tea is cited as the first Indian GI-tagged product, while Kangra Tea shows that separate EU protection is a distinct legal step. C. Kangra Tea proves that every Indian GI automatically enjoys global validity. D. Neither case has any relevance to understanding how GI works.

Answer: B.

Explanation: B is correct because Darjeeling and Kangra are the textbook contrast cases in the GI chapter. The other options confuse goods, legal reach and topic purpose.

Q23. Which statement best reflects the international legal frame of GI?

A. GI protection has no relation to international intellectual-property frameworks. B. Only domestic state tourism departments can recognise a GI. C. The Paris Convention and TRIPS matter to GI discussions, while WIPO distinguishes sui generis protection, certification or collective marks, and business-practice routes. D. Once a GI is registered, no comparative IP language is needed.

Answer: C.

Explanation: C is correct because Nitin explicitly locates GI within international IPR frameworks and WIPO's three protection methods. The other options erase that legal context.

Q24. Which statement about the 2026 Oeko-Tex and Eri-silk route is safest?

A. Topic 12 holds a full dated official list of Oeko-Tex criteria and certified Indian producers. B. Because Eri silk is covered, the certification part may be freely guessed. C. The question is useless because no part of it can be answered. D. The production fact is covered - Eri silk in Meghalaya with named weaver communities - but the certification criteria remain a bounded gap and should not be invented.

Answer: D.

Explanation: D is correct because the repair deliberately separates the answerable production half from the unverified certification half. The other choices either invent or over-deny.

Q25. Which statement about Khadi is safest?

A. Nitin links Khadi to hand-spun cloth, the 1925 All India Spinners' Association and later KVIC promotion. B. Khadi belongs only to medieval court luxury and has no nationalist association. C. Khadi is simply another name for Muga silk. D. Khadi entered Indian history only with the GI Act.

Answer: A.

Explanation: A is correct because it preserves the nationalist and post-independence institutional chronology. The other options detach Khadi from its core historical meaning.

Q26. Which statement about dated GI numbers is safest?

A. The 658-goods figure and the Uttar Pradesh 77-products figure should be quoted as timeless current facts. B. The book's 658 total for July 2025 and Uttar Pradesh's 77 products for April 2025 are dated claims and should not be turned into undated present figures. C. All GI counts are forbidden even when a source dates them clearly. D. Because the counts are dated, the GI chapter should be ignored entirely.

Answer: B.

Explanation: B is correct because the repair retains the figures with date discipline. The other choices either freeze dynamic data or overreact by discarding useful evidence.

Q27. Which statement best captures the appropriation problem discussed in this topic?

A. A GI automatically prevents every form of design copying everywhere. B. Once a craft enters e-commerce, questions of authenticity disappear. C. Because a GI protects a name rather than every motif, design copying and benefit-sharing disputes may survive outside the protected name. D. Appropriation is impossible in textile markets because all traditional forms are public domain.

Answer: C.

Explanation: C is correct because it identifies where name-protection ends and copying disputes can begin. The other options are absolutist and false.

Q28. Which statement about production logic is safest?

A. Banarasi brocade, Chikankari and Kalamkari are identical because all appear on cloth. B. Embroidery, painting-printing and loom weaving should be treated as one craft family with no internal distinction. C. If a textile is colourful, it is safest to classify it as tie-and-dye. D. A sound answer separates woven structure, dye logic, surface printing or painting, and post-weaving embroidery.

Answer: D.

Explanation: D is correct because Topic 12 depends on production discrimination. The other options reduce textile study to visual impression.

Q29. Which statement most safely marks a subject boundary?

A. Kalamkari in Topic 12 is taught as textile surface process and market ecology, while the full painting-school aesthetic history belongs to Topic 7. B. Topic 12 owns every aspect of Indian painting because textiles can be painted. C. GI belongs only to UNESCO and therefore to Topic 14 alone. D. Any question on deindustrialisation should be answered only from craft names.

Answer: A.

Explanation: A is correct because it preserves the boundary between textile craft logic and painting-school history. The other options erase the ownership discipline.

Q30. Which statement about adjacent 2024 Mains routes is safest?

A. Topic 12 owns the full sociological correlation debate on diversity and marginality. B. Topic 12 supplies craft-material vocabulary for deindustrialisation and livelihood illustration for diversity-marginality, but the larger causal or sociological verdict belongs elsewhere. C. Topic 12 has no relation at all to any adjacent Mains route. D. Because the questions are adjacent, Topic 12 should invent economic data to answer them fully.

Answer: B.

Explanation: B is correct because it states the support role honestly without claiming ownership of other subjects' main analytical burden.

Q31. Which statement about North-East production sequence is correct?

A. The book treats North-East weaving as exclusively machine-based and divorced from older technique. B. The region matters only for colour preferences, not for craft process. C. Nitin explicitly notes a traditional sequence of ginning, spinning and weaving across the North-East handloom field. D. North-East textiles appear in the book only as tourism logos.

Answer: C.

Explanation: C is correct because the book explicitly states that traditional ginning, spinning and weaving techniques are used across the region. The distractors deny the technical content of the source.

Q32. Which final exam rule is safest for Topic 12?

A. Memorise only state names and ignore process. B. Prefer a guessed answer letter to an honestly withheld one. C. Write all folk or tribal traditions as timeless and anonymous. D. Build every answer from region plus technique plus product plus community or market context, and qualify any dynamic or unverified claim.

Answer: D.

Explanation: D is correct because it expresses the repair standard for the whole topic. The other options repeat the exact errors this package was built to eliminate.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED OBJECTIVE / APPLICATION PYQS

PYQ 1. CSE 2018 - Regional textile craft heritage Puthukkuli / Sujni / Uppada pairs

Consider the following pairs: (CSE 2018)

Craft Heritage of

1. Puthukkuli shawls - Tamil Nadu
2. Sujni embroidery - Maharashtra
3. Uppada Jamdani sarees - Karnataka

Which of the pairs given above is/are correct? (a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2 (c) 3 only (d) 2 and 3

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Concept analysis:

- Puthukkuli in this PYQ points to the Toda embroidered-shawl route of the Nilgiris / Tamil Nadu. Official checks used in this repair: IP India's Toda Embroidery record lists the geographical area as Tamil Nadu, and Tamil Nadu Tourism notes Toda women wearing the traditional embroidered shawl with GI status.
- Sujini or Sujni belongs to Bihar, not Maharashtra. The Incredible India page on Sujini Embroidery Work of Bihar and the IP India Sujini record both support the Bihar route.
- Uppada Jamdani Sarees belong to Andhra Pradesh. IP India's application details page for Uppada Jamdani lists Andhra Pradesh as the geographical area and names local weaving bodies as applicants.

PYQ 2. CSE 2026 - Oeko-Tex certification for Eri silk in the global textile industry

Which of the following is/are the most significant implication(s) of obtaining Oeko-Tex certification for Eri Silk in the global textile industry?

1. It allows Indian exporters to compete in high-end markets that prioritise chemical-free products.
2. It confirms that Eri Silk meets international safety, environmental, and quality standards, enabling its entry into premium eco-conscious markets.

Select the answer using the code given below: (a) 1 only (b) 2 only (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Answer withheld pending official UPSC key.

Concept analysis:

- The production half of the wider route is covered: Nitin explicitly states that Eri silk is commonly produced in Meghalaya and links it to Garo, Khasi and Jaintia weavers.
- The certification half remains a bounded gap in the canonical audit. This repository does not hold a dated official source for Oeko-Tex criteria, scope, issuing standards or verified producer-status evidence that would let Topic 12 confirm statement 1 or 2 safely.
- Therefore the correct pedagogic move is distinction, not invention: private or voluntary textile certification is not the same instrument as a statutory GI, and no further scheme detail should be fabricated here.

DIRECT MAINS PYQ STATUS

No direct GS-I Mains PYQ is routed solely to Topic 12 in the audited routing bank. The 2024 deindustrialisation and diversity-marginality questions remain adjacent routes owned primarily by Modern History / Economy and Indian Society respectively. Topic 12 supports them with craft vocabulary and livelihood evidence but does not count them here as direct solved Mains PYQs.

ORIGINAL MAINS MODEL ANSWERS

Original Q1. Distinguish handicraft, handloom and GI in the study of Indian craft traditions. (10 marks, 150 words)

Must-write keywords: handicraft, handloom, GI, production chain, authorised users

Model answer: Indian craft questions become sharper when three categories are separated at the start. Handicraft is the wider hand-made field of glass, cloth, clay, metal, wood, leather, toys and related forms. Handloom is a narrower textile subset where cloth is woven on the loom and later differentiated by processes such as Ikat, Jamdani or brocade. GI is not a craft type at all; it is origin-linked intellectual property under the 1999 Act, in force from 2003, protecting a product name for authorised users.

The distinction matters analytically. Patola and Kanchipuram are handloom traditions; Dhokra and glassware are handicrafts but not handlooms; Darjeeling Tea is a GI case but not a handloom or handicraft. Thus craft survival cannot be assessed only through legal registration. One must trace raw material, technique, producing community, market access and later institutional support. In short, handicraft identifies the production field, handloom identifies one textile branch within it, and GI identifies a later legal safeguard whose reach is real but limited.

Original Q2. Explain why Indian craft traditions should be studied as material-technique-community-market systems rather than as isolated decorative objects. (15 marks, 250 words)

Must-write keywords: craft ecology, community, market, transmission, livelihood

Model answer: Indian craft traditions are better understood as systems than as isolated objects because the finished product is only the visible end of a longer chain. Nitin's opening definition of handicrafts already combines livelihood and cultural heritage, especially for rural and tribal communities. This means that a craft must be read through raw material, technique, artisan community, patron or market, transmission and institutional support.

The logic becomes clearer through examples. Meghalaya's Eri-silk weaving can be written only by naming the Garo, Khasi and Jaintia weavers, the fibre and the garments. Dhokra is meaningful not as a museum object alone but as lost-wax metal casting practiced by artisan communities across central and eastern India. Toda embroidered shawls become analytically richer when linked to community identity, GI visibility and tourism-led sale rather than to ornament alone.

This systems approach also explains decline and continuity. A craft may remain legally recognised yet weaken if raw material access, fair pricing or apprenticeship breaks down. Conversely, a tradition may change patrons - court, merchant, tourism, digital platform - while preserving technical memory. Therefore continuity in Indian crafts does not mean unchanged production; it means the reorganisation of a skill under shifting material and market conditions. A strong UPSC answer should therefore move from object to chain, not the other way round.

Original Q3. Compare Patola, Pochampally, Kanchipuram and Banarasi as region-technique-product systems. (15 marks, 250 words)

Must-write keywords: double Ikat, border joining, brocade, region-technique-product, close options

Model answer: Patola, Pochampally, Kanchipuram and Banarasi should be compared through region-technique-product matching because their visual richness often causes close-option mistakes. Patola is safest as Patan's double Ikat tradition. Pochampally belongs to Telangana and remains in the Ikat family, but its centre and design history differ from Patola. Kanchipuram silk is marked by the contrasting borders joined to the body, while Banarasi belongs to the brocade and supplementary-weft zari tradition of Varanasi.

This comparison matters because each tradition represents a different production logic within the larger cloth-handicraft world. Patola and Pochampally foreground dye planning before weaving; Kanchipuram foregrounds structural joining and silk weaving; Banarasi foregrounds brocaded luxury cloth. The four thus show that Indian handloom history is not one uniform textile stream but a cluster of specialised weaving systems.

The qualification is equally important. Region names alone are insufficient; one must write process. A student who knows only that Patola is from Gujarat may still confuse it with Bandhani or Tangaliya. Similarly, Banarasi should not be called embroidery just because zari is visible. Therefore the best exam method is threefold: state the locality, name the technique and then tie it to the product form. That converts memorisation into evidence.

Original Q4. 'A GI protects a name, not a livelihood.' Critically examine with suitable examples from Indian craft and textile traditions. (20 marks, 250 words)

Must-write keywords: GI, name protection, livelihood, Darjeeling, Kangra, appropriation

Model answer: The statement is substantially correct, though incomplete unless its importance is also acknowledged. A GI is a legal instrument under the Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999, brought into force in 2003. It protects an origin-linked product name for authorised users. In that sense, it is a narrow but real intellectual-property shield.

Examples show both its power and its limit. Darjeeling Tea, the first Indian GI-tagged product, illustrates the symbolic and legal value of origin-linked recognition. Kangra Tea's later EU protection shows that such recognition can even travel abroad through additional registration. Uppada Jamdani's official GI record also shows how cooperative and weaver-association bodies can enter the protection framework.

Yet livelihood depends on more than legal exclusivity. A GI does not automatically secure raw material, working capital, fair price, design control, ecological sustainability or intergenerational apprenticeship. That is why a GI-tagged tradition may still face imitation outside the protected name, weak benefit-sharing or market capture by intermediaries. The Oeko-Tex and Eri-silk route makes the same point differently: certification and marketing language are separate from source-supported production facts.

Therefore a critical answer should call GI necessary but insufficient. It helps defend identity in the market, but the survival of a living craft still depends on the earlier chain of material, labour, community power and institutional support.

Original Q5. Discuss the North-East handloom traditions of India with special reference to community, fibre and garment. (10 marks, 150 words)

Must-write keywords: Muga, Eri, community, Moirang Phee, Puan

Model answer: North-East handloom traditions are best written through a community-fibre-garment formula. Assam is known for silk production, especially golden Muga, used in sarees and mekhela chadors. Meghalaya is the key Eri route in Nitin's evidence bank: the Garo, Khasi and Jaintia communities are named as skilled weavers, and Eri silk is linked to shawls, sarongs and mekhela chadors made in silk and cotton.

Manipur adds named garments and textiles such as Moirang Phee and Phanek. Nagaland's textiles are differentiated by tribe-specific patterns and natural-dye use rather than by one uniform regional style. Mizoram's Puan is important

both as a cloth form and as a clue to women's weaving labour.

The larger significance is analytical. These examples show that North-East textile traditions are not generic 'tribal crafts' but differentiated community systems. The main qualification is that shared garments like the mekhela chador cannot, by themselves, identify a state; the fibre and community must also be stated.

Original Q6. Examine how embroidery and surface-decoration traditions such as Chikankari, Sujini, Kantha, Phulkari and Kalamkari reflect both continuity and change. (15 marks, 250 words)

Must-write keywords: surface process, embroidery, storytelling, continuity, change

Model answer: Indian surface-decoration traditions show continuity of skill but change in context, material and market. Chikankari remains recognisable as Lucknow's white-thread embroidery, Kantha as Bengal's running-stitch quilting or embroidery, Sujini as Bihar's narrative embroidery, and Phulkari as flower-like darning work of the Punjab-Haryana belt. Kalamkari, though technically different because it is painted or printed cotton rather than embroidery, belongs in the same analytical conversation because it demonstrates how surface treatment can define a textile tradition.

Their continuity lies in inherited technical memory and region-specific identity. Chamba Rumal even shows how one textile form can absorb another art-historical influence, namely Pahari painting, without ceasing to be embroidery. Sujini's official tourism description adds another dimension: textile art can also narrate social memory, injustice and aspiration.

Change enters through market and institutional shifts. Traditions once tied to court, ritual or domestic use now circulate through GI visibility, tourism, exhibitions, e-commerce and state branding. This expands reach but also raises authenticity and benefit-sharing questions. Thus continuity should not be mistaken for unchanged social location. The safest conclusion is that Indian embroidery and surface-decoration traditions endure by adapting their circulation while retaining a recognisable technical core.